

Abstract

This seminar paper identifies and evaluates emerging technologies destined to redefine immersive retail by using a framework of three core evaluative factors derived from a systematic literature review. The first theme, consumer experience, assesses technological value through the lens of utilitarian efficiency and hedonic stimulation. It emphasizes that adoption is primarily driven by perceived ease of use and the ability of a tool to satisfy specific consumer "do-goals" or "be-goals." The second theme, technology value, focuses on "diagnosticity", the technical capacity of a tool to provide accurate, high-fidelity product information, such as texture and scale. This ensures the technology functions as a legitimate utility that solves physical-to-digital pain points rather than serving as a temporary marketing gimmick. Supporting this value is the necessary technical infrastructure, which requires high-performance standards like latency below 10ms and edge computing to handle graphic-intensive rendering without disrupting the user experience. Finally, economic viability checks if a retailer can actually sustain the technology over time. This involves balancing the high upfront investment costs against the potential for profit and the ability to scale the system efficiently. By applying these criteria to case studies of Holograms, Neurotechnology, and Agentic AI, the study identifies Agentic AI as the most viable future innovation due to its high scores across all three dimensions. These findings provide a strategic roadmap for retailers to evaluate future innovations and maintain a competitive advantage in an increasingly immersive digital landscape.

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1 Introduction

Over the past two decades, technology has evolved rapidly and has impacted various industries including retail. Technology such as artificial reality and virtual reality have an impact on the retail industry. These technologies create an immersive experience for the consumers.

While immersive retail technology such as artificial reality, virtual reality, and metaverse have been thoroughly researched. Research related to these technologies evaluate their effects and explore their practical applications. However, considering their growing use in the existing retail industry, these immersive retail technologies are already relevant in the present. There is more research required to identify future technology and their relevance for immersive retail.

To address the research gap, this paper will highlight potential future technology that already exists and evaluate their relevance for the future of immersive retail. To do so, there is a systematic literature review to identify themes that have been used in the past to study immersive retail technology and their adoption. These are used to evaluate the relevance of future technologies studied in this seminar paper.

Identifying these future technologies and their relevance will provide retailers to develop their vision and business strategy for future. Furthermore, the themes identified can be utilized by retailers to evaluate other types of technology and their relevance in regard to a retailer's intention to adopt them.